

CLAT Express - May 2026: Study Notes

Chapters, topics and sub-topics with key facts, memory aids and mind-map outlines.

International Relations and News

PM Modi Visit to 5 Nations

UAE Visit: Strategic Outcomes

PM Modi's UAE visit produced agreements and proposals on energy security, LPG supply, shipbuilding and defence, and AI infrastructure. The energy outcomes centre on strategic crude storage and an LPG supply partnership with ADNOC. Investment interest in India's infrastructure sector was also noted.

- MoU between Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited and Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC) for strategic collaboration.
- Proposal to store up to 30 million barrels of ADNOC crude oil in India's Strategic Petroleum Reserves.
- Discussions on storing crude oil in Fujairah under India's Overseas Strategic Reserve Framework.
- IOCL and ADNOC signed a strategic collaboration agreement on LPG supply security; a long-term LPG sale deal between ADNOC Gas and IOCL is a potential deal.
- Framework advanced for a Strategic Defence Partnership between India and the UAE.
- Cochin Shipyard and Drydocks World MoU to establish a Ship Repair Cluster at Vadinar.
- Cooperation includes offshore fabrication under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme.
- Term sheet signed for setting up 8 Exaflop Super Computing Clusters.
- Partnership between C-DAC and G42 under India's AI Mission.
- Abu Dhabi Investment Authority and National Infrastructure and Investment Fund to explore investments up to US\$1 billion in India's infrastructure sector.

Mind-map outline

UAE visit outcomes

- Energy and petroleum
 - 30 million barrels ADNOC crude proposal
 - Fujairah crude storage talks
 - IOCL-ADNOC LPG supply pact
- Defence and shipbuilding
 - Strategic Defence Partnership framework
 - Ship Repair Cluster at Vadinar
 - Offshore fabrication under Maritime Development Fund
- AI and investment
 - 8 Exaflop supercomputing clusters
 - C-DAC and G42 partnership
 - Investment up to US\$1 billion

UAE: Trade, Diaspora and Country Profile

India-UAE trade in FY 2025-26 stood at US\$100 billion, and the UAE is among India's largest energy suppliers and export destinations. The 2022 CEPA and the UAE's share of India's remittance flows are key economic links. The booklet also profiles the UAE's government and the Kafala sponsorship system.

- Trade between India and the UAE in FY 2025-26: US\$100 billion.
- UAE is India's 2nd largest export destination, after the US.
- UAE is India's 3rd largest crude oil source.
- UAE is India's 3rd largest supplier of LNG and 2nd largest supplier of LPG.
- UAE is the only nation participating in India's Strategic Reserve Programme.
- In 2022, India was the first country with which the UAE signed a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA).
- UAE accounted for 18% of India's remittance flows.
- UAE is a federal, elective monarchy of 7 emirates; capital Abu Dhabi; currency dirham.

- Kafala system: a sponsorship system in Gulf countries that ties a foreign worker's visa and legal status to an in-country sponsor, typically the employer.
- Indian nationals form the largest expatriate community within the UAE.

Mnemonic - UAE trade rankings: Tiny Elephants Cross Large Pools

Tiny = Trade: US\$100 billion in FY 2025-26; Elephants = UAE is India's 2nd largest export destination, after the US; Cross = UAE is India's 3rd largest crude oil source; Large = UAE is India's 3rd largest LNG supplier; Pools = UAE is India's 2nd largest LPG supplier

Mind-map outline

UAE profile and ties

- Trade and energy partner
 - Trade US\$100 billion in FY 2025-26
 - 2nd largest export destination
 - 3rd largest crude oil source
- Agreements
 - CEPA signed in 2022
 - Only nation in India's Strategic Reserve Programme
- Remittances and people
 - 18% of India's remittance flows
 - Indians: largest expatriate community
- Country and labour
 - Federal elective monarchy of 7 emirates
 - Kafala: employer-linked sponsorship

Norway, Nordic Group and Sweden

PM Modi made the first bilateral visit by an Indian PM to Norway in 43 years and attended the 3rd India-Nordic Summit in Oslo. Ties with Norway were upgraded to a Green Strategic Partnership, and ties with Sweden were elevated to a Strategic Partnership. The core Nordic group has five countries.

- PM Modi undertook the first bilateral visit by an Indian PM to Norway in 43 years.
- The 3rd India-Nordic Summit was held in Oslo; earlier summits were in Stockholm (2018) and Copenhagen (2022).
- India and Norway upgraded ties to a Green Strategic Partnership covering clean energy transition, climate resilience, blue economy and green shipping.
- Norway formally joined India's Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative.
- PM Modi was awarded Norway's highest civilian honour, the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.
- India-EFTA TEPA was signed in 2024.
- Norwegian Sovereign Wealth Fund (GPF) has invested about USD 28 billion in India.
- Core Nordic countries: Denmark, Finland, Iceland (least populous), Norway and Sweden (most populous).
- India and Sweden elevated ties to a Strategic Partnership and adopted the India-Sweden Joint Action Plan 2026-2030.
- India and Sweden launched LeadIT at the UN Climate Action Summit in 2019 and endorsed joint development of SITAC, the India-Sweden Technology and Artificial Intelligence Corridor.

Mnemonic - Core Nordic countries: Dancers Find Icy Nordic Summers

D = Denmark; F = Finland; I = Iceland (least populous); N = Norway; S = Sweden (most populous)

Mind-map outline

Norway, Nordics and Sweden

- Norway visit
 - First bilateral visit in 43 years
 - Green Strategic Partnership
 - Joined Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative
- Nordic summits
 - 3rd summit held in Oslo
 - Earlier: Stockholm 2018, Copenhagen 2022
 - Core Nordic group: five countries
- Sweden ties

- Strategic Partnership upgrade
- Joint Action Plan 2026-2030
- SITAC and SME-startup platform

Italy and Netherlands: Partnerships and Heritage

India and Italy upgraded ties to a Special Strategic Partnership, targeting EUR 20 billion in bilateral trade by 2029 and backing the IMEEC corridor. Cooperation with the Netherlands covers semiconductors, water management and the return of 11th-century Chola copper plates. The booklet also places the Afsluitdijk Dam in the Netherlands alongside the proposed Kalpasar Project in Gujarat.

- India and Italy upgraded bilateral relations to a Special Strategic Partnership.
- India and Italy committed to raising bilateral trade to EUR 20 billion by 2029.
- Both nations support IMEEC, which aims to improve trade connectivity, logistics, energy and digital links between Asia and Europe.
- 2027 is declared the Year of Culture and Tourism between India and Italy, marking 80 years of diplomatic relations.
- Italy is India's 4th largest trading partner in the EU.
- MoU between Tata Electronics and ASML supports India's semiconductor plant in Dholera, Gujarat.
- Leiden University returned 11th-century Chola copper plates (Anaimangalam Copper Plates) to India.
- Afsluitdijk Dam: a 32 km long barrier dam in the Netherlands that transformed the saline Zuiderzee inlet into freshwater IJsselmeer Lake.
- Kalpasar Project (Gujarat): proposed dam across the Gulf of Khambhat, expected to create the world's largest freshwater reservoir.
- Kalpasar objectives: freshwater storage, flood control, climate resilience, irrigation support and regional development.

Mnemonic - Kalpasar objectives: Fresh Floods Can Irrigate Regions

Fresh = Freshwater storage; Floods = Flood control; Can = Climate resilience; Irrigate = Irrigation support; Regions = Regional development

Mind-map outline

Italy and Netherlands

- Italy
 - Special Strategic Partnership
 - EUR 20 billion trade target by 2029
 - 2027: Year of Culture and Tourism
- Netherlands
 - Tata Electronics-ASML semiconductor MoU
 - Anaimangalam Copper Plates returned
 - Afsluitdijk: 32 km barrier dam
- Water projects
 - Kalpasar: dam across Gulf of Khambhat
 - Freshwater storage and flood control
 - Target: world's largest freshwater reservoir

UAE's Exit from OPEC and OPEC+

UAE's Exit from OPEC and OPEC+

The United Arab Emirates announced that it will leave OPEC and the wider OPEC+ alliance, effective 01 May 2026. The exit is seen as a major geopolitical shift that could weaken OPEC's influence over the global oil market. OPEC+ brings OPEC together with major non-OPEC producers, and the alliance pumps around 40% of the world's crude oil.

- UAE joined OPEC in 1967.
- UAE's exit from OPEC and OPEC+ is effective 01 May 2026.
- The exit is seen as a major geopolitical shift.
- The exit could weaken OPEC's influence over the global oil market.
- The exit reduces the group's collective ability to control global oil prices.
- OPEC+ is an alliance of OPEC and 11 major non-OPEC producers, formed in 2016.

- OPEC+ pumps around 40% of the world's crude oil.

Mind-map outline

UAE exit from OPEC and OPEC+

- Effective 01 May 2026
- UAE joined OPEC in 1967
- Seen as major geopolitical shift
- OPEC+ formed in 2016
- OPEC+ pumps around 40% of world crude

OPEC: Origin, Mandate and Membership

OPEC was established in 1960 at the Baghdad Conference and is headquartered in Vienna, Austria. Its mandate is to protect oil exporters' interests by coordinating production policies for stable supply and fair returns. It acts as a regulatory authority for the international energy market, using production quotas to prevent extreme fluctuations in crude oil prices.

- Established in 1960 at the Baghdad Conference.
- Founding members: Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia and Venezuela.
- Headquarters in Vienna, Austria.
- Mandate: protect oil exporters' interests through coordinated production policies.
- Uses production quotas to prevent extreme fluctuations in crude oil prices.
- After the UAE's exit, OPEC has 11 members.
- Members include Algeria, Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Gabon, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Libya, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia and Venezuela.
- Ecuador suspended its membership in 1992; Gabon terminated its membership in January 1995.
- All OPEC member countries are signatories to the UNFCCC.

Mnemonic - OPEC founding members: Iranian Iraqi Kings Sail Venice

I = Iran, a founding member; I = Iraq, a founding member; K = Kuwait, a founding member; S = Saudi Arabia, a founding member; V = Venezuela, a founding member

Mind-map outline

OPEC

- Origin
 - 1960, Baghdad Conference
 - Founders: Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, Venezuela
- Mandate
 - Protect oil exporters' interests
 - Stable supply, fair returns
- Tools
 - Production quotas
- Membership
 - 11 members after UAE exit
 - HQ: Vienna, Austria

Reasons Behind the Exit and Its Impact

Production quota limits stopped the UAE from fully using its expanding oil capacity, and it aims for about 5 million barrels/day by 2027. The UAE also expects global oil demand to peak soon and then decline, so it wants strong oil revenues now while preparing for the energy transition.

Long-standing tensions with Saudi Arabia over production policy add to the pressures behind the exit.

- Production quota constraints limited the UAE's ability to fully use its expanding oil capacity.
- The UAE aims to reach about 5 million barrels/day by 2027.
- The UAE holds the world's 6th largest oil reserves.
- The UAE predicts an imminent peak in global oil demand, followed by gradual decline.
- Strategy: maximise short-term oil revenues while preparing for a long-term transition to renewables.
- Oil revenues are meant to fund AI and data centre growth, driving a diversified economy.
- Long-standing tensions with Saudi Arabia over production policy within OPEC.
- Independent production strategies may lead to greater price volatility.

- Peak Oil Theory, proposed by M. King Hubbert, says production follows a bell-shaped curve before irreversible decline.

Mnemonic - UAE's reasons for exit: Quiet Peacocks Seek New Insight

Q = Quota constraints limited use of expanding capacity; P = Peak in global oil demand expected imminently; S = Short-term oil revenues are the strategy; N = National interest: revenue to fund AI and data centres; I = Internal OPEC tensions with Saudi Arabia

Mind-map outline

Reasons and impact of exit

- Quota limits
 - Capacity not fully used
- Demand outlook
 - Imminent peak in oil demand
- Strategy
 - Short-term oil revenues
 - Long-term renewables transition
- Rivalry
 - Tensions with Saudi Arabia
- Market impact
 - Weaker collective discipline
 - Greater price volatility

Habshan-Fujairah Pipeline and India's Stake

The Habshan-Fujairah pipeline is a crude oil pipeline in the UAE that carries oil from inland fields to a port on the Gulf of Oman, bypassing the Strait of Hormuz. It boosts UAE export flexibility, which matters amid Strait of Hormuz disruption risks. For India, lower oil prices would reduce import costs and ease inflationary pressure.

- Crude oil pipeline in the UAE.
- Connects inland oil fields of Habshan to the port of Fujairah on the Gulf of Oman.
- Bypasses the Strait of Hormuz.
- Boosts UAE export flexibility and enables higher output amid Strait of Hormuz disruption risks.
- India stands to gain from decreased oil prices.
- Lower prices would reduce India's import costs and mitigate inflationary pressures.
- The shift allows direct bilateral negotiations outside traditional cartel restrictions.
- Supports India's de-dollarisation by encouraging energy settlements in rupees.
- Heightened market volatility could complicate India's long-term energy budgeting.

Mind-map outline

Habshan-Fujairah and India

- Pipeline
 - Inland Habshan to Fujairah port
 - Bypasses Strait of Hormuz
- Export flexibility
 - Higher output amid Hormuz risks
- India gains
 - Lower import costs
 - Less inflationary pressure
 - Rupee energy settlements

National News and Issues

NEET Paper Leak Controversy

NEET-UG 2026 cancellation and re-test

NEET-UG 2026 was declared compromised after paper leak allegations, and the examination was officially cancelled. Reports of illicit leaks and unauthorised material on digital platforms led to an investigation, and fraudulent guess papers that closely mirrored the actual test were among the evidence. The NTA voided the initial results and ordered a re-test for all candidates without any further application cost.

- NEET 2026 was declared compromised amid paper leak allegations.
- Official cancellation of NEET-UG 2026 was followed by a planned re-sitting.
- Reports of illicit paper leaks and unauthorised exam materials on digital platforms triggered an investigation.
- Fraudulent 'guess papers' that closely mirrored the actual test were part of the evidence.
- NTA decided to void the initial results to maintain integrity and public trust.
- The re-test is to be administered again for all candidates.
- Candidates do not have to pay any further application costs for the re-test.

Mind-map outline

NEET-UG 2026 cancellation

- Trigger
 - Paper leak allegations
 - Guess papers mirrored real test
- Action
 - Official cancellation
 - Initial results voided
 - Nationwide re-test
- Cost to candidates
 - No further application fee

NEET, NTA and the 2024 controversy

NEET is the National Entrance Examination for admission into medical colleges across India, and it is conducted by the National Testing Agency. The NTA was established in 2017 as an autonomous body under the Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education. The NEET-UG 2024 controversy, marked by an unusually high number of full-mark scorers, led to a high-level committee headed by former ISRO Chairman Dr K Radhakrishnan.

- NEET is the National Entrance Examination for admission into medical colleges across India.
- NEET-UG is conducted by the National Testing Agency.
- The NTA was established in 2017.
- The NTA is an autonomous body under the Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education.
- The NTA's headquarters are in New Delhi and its head is Pradeep Kumar Joshi.
- The NTA also conducts JEE Main and CUET.
- In 2024, an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks.
- Only two candidates secured full marks in 2023, and no candidate did in 2022.
- After the NEET-UG 2024 controversy, the Ministry of Education constituted a high-level committee headed by former ISRO Chairman Dr K Radhakrishnan.

Mind-map outline

NEET and NTA

- NEET
 - Entrance for medical colleges
 - Conducted by NTA
- NTA
 - Established 2017
 - Under Higher Education dept
 - HQ in New Delhi
- 2024 controversy
 - Unusually high full-mark scorers
 - 2023: two full marks
 - 2022: no full marks
 - High-level committee formed

Ripple effect of exam malpractice

Exam malpractice damages far more than a single examination. It lowers the value of academic credentials, adds financial burden on government institutions and erodes public trust in fairness. Students also suffer, as cancellations delay admissions and honest candidates face stress and demotivation.

- Loss of system credibility reduces the market value of degrees and merit rankings.
- Re-conducting compromised examinations imposes a heavy financial burden on government institutions.
- Large-scale cheating makes parents and students lose confidence in educational fairness.
- Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students.
- Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for honest candidates.
- The impacts are grouped into systemic and institutional damage, and impact on students.

Mnemonic - Impacts of malpractice: Cheating Affects Trust And Pupils

C = Devaluation of academic credentials; A = Escalating administrative costs of re-conducting exams; T = Erosion of public trust; A = Academic and admission disruptions; P = Psychological toll on honest candidates

Mind-map outline

Ripple effects of malpractice

- Credentials
 - Degrees lose market value
 - Merit rankings lose value
- Public trust
 - Parents lose confidence
- Costs
 - Re-test burden on government
- Students
 - Admissions delayed
 - Honest candidates demotivated

Panel recommendations

The panel's major recommendations focus on the role of the NTA, institutional governance, secure examination centres and technology. It proposed limiting the NTA to entrance examinations for higher education institutions and creating 10 new posts. It also recommended a Digi-Yatra-like authentication system and a gradual shift to computer adaptive testing.

- The NTA should focus only on entrance examinations for higher education institutions, not recruitment examinations.
- The panel proposed creating 10 new posts for administration, IT infrastructure and digital security.
- A technology-enabled authentication system similar to Digi-Yatra was proposed under a Digi-Exam framework.
- Governance reforms recommended an empowered governing body with sub-committees for test audits, ethics and transparency, and staff management and appointments.
- Greater use of Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan institutions and Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya campuses as examination centres was recommended.
- Gradual adoption of computer adaptive testing was proposed for future entrance examinations.

Mind-map outline

Panel recommendations

- NTA role
 - Only entrance exams for HEIs
- Governance
 - Empowered governing body
 - Sub-committees: audits, ethics, staff
- Technology
 - Digi-Yatra-like authentication
 - Computer adaptive testing
- Institutions
 - 10 new posts

- KVS and JNV exam centres

Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024

The Act aims to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. It sets imprisonment of 3 to 10 years for individuals, with fines and debarment for service providers and a separate penalty for organised crime. Offences are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable, and investigations can be transferred to a Central Investigating Agency.

- The Act's objective is to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations.
- For individuals, imprisonment ranges from 3 to 10 years depending on the offence, and monetary penalties up to 1 crore apply in organised malpractice.
- Service providers face a fine up to 1 crore and debarment from conducting examinations for 4 years.
- Organised crimes attract imprisonment between 5 and 10 years and a minimum fine of 1 crore.
- Property attachment and forfeiture are possible for organised crimes.
- Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable.
- Investigations are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police.
- The Central Government may transfer investigations to a Central Investigating Agency when required.

Mnemonic - Scope of unfair means: Let Impostors Use Tricks For Money

L = Leakage of question papers or answer keys; I = Candidate impersonation; U = Unauthorised assistance during examinations; T = Tampering with computer systems or networks; F = Conducting fake examinations; M = Manipulating merit lists or official documents

Mind-map outline

Public Examination Act 2024

- Objective
 - Curb paper leaks
 - Curb organised cheating
- Penalties
 - Individuals: 3 to 10 years
 - Service providers: 4-year debarment
 - Organised crime: 5 to 10 years
- Offences
 - Cognisable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
 - Wide scope of unfair means
- Investigation
 - DSP or ACP rank or above
 - Central agency transfer possible

Bhojshala - Kamal Maula Complex

Madhya Pradesh High Court Judgment

The Madhya Pradesh High Court declared the Bhojshala - Kamal Maula Complex a Hindu temple and quashed the 2003 ASI order that allowed shared worship. It held that the Places of Worship Act, 1991 did not apply because the site is a protected monument. The court also directed the State Government to consider alternative land in Dhar for a mosque or prayer site.

- The MP High Court declared the complex a Hindu temple of Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati), based on 2024 ASI survey findings.
- The court quashed the 2003 ASI order that had allowed shared worship at the site.
- The Places of Worship Act, 1991 was held inapplicable because the site falls under the AMASR Act, 1958 as a protected monument.
- Section 4(3) of the Places of Worship Act excludes ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958 from the religious character freeze.
- The Muslim side's reliance on an August 1935 proclamation by the princely State of Dhar was rejected.
- The Government of India Act, 1935 was not enforced until April 1937.

- The case was treated as a Writ Petition under Article 226 seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship.
- Unlike the Babri Masjid dispute (a Title Suit over ownership), the Bhojshala case was a writ petition.
- The State Government was directed to consider allotting alternative land within Dhar for a mosque or prayer site.

Mind-map outline

MP High Court Judgment

- Declared Hindu temple (Vagdevi)
 - Based on 2024 ASI survey
- 2003 ASI order quashed
- Places of Worship Act inapplicable
 - Site is an AMASR protected monument
 - Section 4(3) excludes ancient monuments
- 1935 Dhar proclamation rejected
 - GoI Act 1935 not enforced until Apr 1937
- Writ petition under Article 226
- Alternative land in Dhar for mosque

Places of Worship Act, 1991

The Places of Worship Act, 1991 freezes the religious character of places of worship as it stood on 15 August 1947 and prohibits their conversion. It terminates pre-1947 disputes, allows new cases only for post-1947 changes, and provides penalties for violations. The Act has drawn criticism on grounds of judicial review, federalism, equality and the 1947 cut-off date.

- The Act was passed by the P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government.
- Section 3 prohibits converting a place of worship between or within religious denominations.
- Section 4(1) ensures the religious identity of a place of worship remains as it was on August 15, 1947.
- Section 4(2) terminates legal proceedings on pre-1947 religious character conversions; new cases are allowed only for post-1947 changes.
- Section 5 provides exceptions for ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958 and for the Ayodhya dispute.
- Section 6 provides penalties with a maximum imprisonment term of 3 years, along with fines.
- Critics say the Act bars judicial review, limiting constitutional checks and balances.
- Critics say the Act violates the right to religion (Art 25-28) and undermines equality (Art 14-15).
- Critics say the August 15, 1947 cut-off ignores historical injustices and pre-1947 encroachments.
- The Supreme Court's 2019 Ayodhya verdict said the Act upholds secular values and prohibits retrogression.

Mnemonic - Places of Worship Act sections: Pass Freeze And Exempt Penalty (PFAEP)

P (Pass) = Section 3 prohibits conversion of a place of worship; F (Freeze) = Section 4(1) keeps religious identity as on August 15, 1947; A (And) = Section 4(2) terminates pre-1947 proceedings on religious character conversions; E (Exempt) = Section 5 exempts AMASR Act monuments and the Ayodhya dispute; P (Penalty) = Section 6 sets a maximum of 3 years imprisonment plus fines

Mind-map outline

Places of Worship Act, 1991

- Section 3: no conversion
- Section 4(1): character as on 15 Aug 1947
- Section 4(2): pre-1947 cases terminated
- Section 5: exceptions
 - AMASR monuments
 - Ayodhya dispute
- Section 6: penalties
 - Max 3 years imprisonment
 - Fines
- Criticism
 - Bars judicial review
 - Violates Art 25-28
 - Cut-off ignores historical injustices

Historical and Religious Claims

The site is a medieval ASI-protected monument in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh, traditionally linked to Raja Bhoj, who built it in 1034 AD. Hindus regard it as a Saraswati temple, while Muslims identify it as the Kamal Maula Mosque. It was reportedly converted into a mosque in 1514 AD, and an idol of Goddess Saraswati found at the site is now in the British Museum, London.

- Medieval ASI-protected monument located in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh.
- Hindus claim the site as a Saraswati temple; Muslims consider it a mosque.
- Built by Raja Bhoj in 1034 AD.
- The term 'Bhojshala' became linked to the building in the early 20th century, based on inscriptions found at the site by KK Lele.
- The structure is believed to have originally functioned as a temple dedicated to Goddess Saraswati (Vagdevi).
- Reportedly converted into a mosque in 1514 AD under Muslim rule (Mehmudshah Khilji) in Dhar.
- Muslims identify the structure as the Kamal Maula Mosque, associated with Sufi saint Hazrat Maulana Kamaluddin Chishti.
- An intricately carved idol of Goddess Saraswati was discovered at the site during excavations in the 20th century.
- The Saraswati idol is currently housed in the British Museum, London.
- The site was traditionally regarded as a centre of Sanskrit learning and scholarship.

Mind-map outline

Historical and Religious Claims

- Built by Raja Bhoj, 1034 AD
- Hindu view: Saraswati (Vagdevi) temple
- Muslim view: Kamal Maula Mosque
 - Sufi saint Kamaluddin Chishti
- Converted to mosque, 1514 AD
 - Reportedly under Mehmudshah Khilji
- Saraswati idol
 - Found in 20th century excavations
 - Now in British Museum, London
- Name linked via KK Lele's inscriptions

Architecture, Inscriptions and Gurjara-Pratihara Links

The complex preserves the remains of a Mandapa-style hall, typical of Hindu temple architecture, and two Sarpabandha pillar inscriptions that teach Sanskrit grammar. Its walls carry odes to Kurma Avatara in Prakrit, and its inscriptions mention Paramara rulers. Raja Bhoj, recognized as Mihir Bhoja, is linked to the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire.

- Structural remains indicate a Mandapa-style hall, characteristic of Hindu temple architecture.
- The site uniquely preserves 2 Sarpabandha (serpentine chart) pillar inscriptions.
- The Sarpabandha inscriptions chart the Sanskrit alphabet, noun/verb terminations, and the ten tenses and moods of Sanskrit grammar.
- Stone slabs on the walls carry two odes to Kurma Avatara (Tortoise Incarnation of Vishnu), composed in Prakrit.
- Sanskrit and Pali inscriptions mention Paramara rulers such as Udayaditya, Naravarman and Arjunavarma Deva.
- The Sanskrit drama Karpuramanjari was written by royal tutor Madana, a disciple of Jain scholar Ashadhara.
- Gurjara-Pratihara Empire founder: Nagabhata I (730-756 AD).
- Raja Bhoj (Mihir Bhoja) was the most illustrious emperor of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire.
- Capital of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire: Kannauj (Mahodaya).
- The Pratiharas were central to a tripartite struggle against the Palas of Bengal and the Rashtrakutas of the Deccan.

Mnemonic - Sarpabandha pillar lessons: Ants Need Teachers

A = Sanskrit alphabet charted by the Sarpabandha pillar inscriptions; N = Noun and verb terminations charted by the inscriptions; T = Ten tenses and moods of Sanskrit grammar charted by the inscriptions

Mind-map outline

Architecture and Inscriptions

- Mandapa-style hall
 - Characteristic of Hindu temple architecture
- 2 Sarpabandha pillar inscriptions
 - Sanskrit alphabet
 - Noun/verb terminations
 - Ten tenses and moods
- Kurma Avatara odes in Prakrit
- Paramara rulers named
 - Udayaditya, Naravarman, Arjunavarma Deva
- Gurjara-Pratihara link
 - Raja Bhoj as Mihir Bhoja
 - Capital: Kannauj (Mahodaya)

Polity & Governance

Increase in Supreme Court Judge Strength

Expansion Bill and Legal Framework

The Union Cabinet approved the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill 2026 to expand the Court to 38 judges, which is the Chief Justice plus 37 other judges. Article 124 empowers Parliament to change the number of judges by law, and the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 governs this. The Court was inaugurated in 1950 and succeeded the Federal Court of India.

- Cabinet approved the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill 2026
- Proposed strength is 38 judges (CJI plus 37 other judges)
- Article 124 empowers Parliament to increase judges by law
- Governed by the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956
- Increase needs an Amendment Bill passed by both Houses
- Simple majority is sufficient; Presidential assent is also needed
- Inaugurated on 28 January 1950
- Succeeded the Federal Court of India (Government of India Act, 1935)
- Replaced the British Privy Council as the highest court of appeal
- Originally fixed at 8 (Chief Justice and 7 other judges)

Mind-map outline

Expanding SC Strength

- Legal basis
 - Article 124 empowers Parliament
 - Number of Judges Act, 1956
- Procedure
 - Amendment Bill in both Houses
 - Simple majority
 - Presidential assent
- Strength
 - Proposed 38 judges
 - Originally 8 judges

Qualifications, Tenure and Removal

Judges of the Supreme Court are appointed by the President, subject to qualifications set in the Constitution. A judge holds office until the age of 65 and may resign by writing to the President. Removal is only on grounds of proven misbehaviour or incapacity, under the Judges Enquiry Act, 1968, and needs a Parliamentary vote.

- Judges are appointed by the President
- Must be a citizen of India
- Five years as a High Court judge is one qualification route
- A Distinguished Jurist in the President's opinion is another route
- No fixed tenure; holds office until 65 years of age

- A judge may resign by writing to the President
- Removal only on proven misbehaviour or incapacity
- Removal by the President on Parliament's recommendation
- Judges Enquiry Act, 1968 governs the removal procedure for SC and HC judges
- Justice Soumitra Sen (2011) resigned before Lok Sabha discussion

Mind-map outline

Judges: Tenure and Removal

- Tenure
 - Holds office till 65 years
 - Resignation by letter to President
- Removal
 - Proven misbehaviour or incapacity
 - Parliament's recommendation
 - Judges Enquiry Act, 1968
- Cases
 - Ramaswami (1993): motion failed
 - Soumitra Sen (2011): resigned
 - Nagarjuna (2017): failed for lack of signatures

CJI Appointment Convention and Collegium

Until 1973 the seniormost judge was normally appointed Chief Justice of India, a convention that was broken in 1973 and 1977. The Second Judges Case (1993) ruled that only the seniormost judge should be appointed CJI and that consultation means concurrence. The 2015 Fourth Judges Case struck down the NJAC and the 99th Amendment.

- Till 1973, the seniormost judge was normally appointed CJI
- 1973: AN Ray appointed CJI, superseding JM Shelat, KS Hegde and AN Grover
- 1977: MU Beg appointed CJI, superseding HR Khanna
- 1981 (First Judges Case): consultation only implies exchange of views
- 1993 (Second Judges Case): consultation changed to mean concurrence
- 1993: only the seniormost judge should be appointed CJI
- 1998 (Third Judges Case): CJI must consult a collegium of 4 seniormost judges
- 1998: if 2 judges give an adverse opinion, no recommendation is sent
- 2015 (Fourth Judges Case): 99th Amendment and NJAC Act declared void
- NJAC: CJI chairperson, 2 seniormost judges, Law Minister, 2 eminent persons

Mnemonic - Judges Cases Sequence: Eager Cats Can Sleep

E (1981) = First Judges Case: consultation means exchange of views, not concurrence; C (1993) = Second Judges Case: consultation means concurrence; C (1998) = Third Judges Case: consult a collegium of 4 seniormost judges; S (2015) = Fourth Judges Case: NJAC and 99th Amendment declared void

Mind-map outline

CJI Appointment and Collegium

- Convention
 - Seniormost judge normally CJI
 - Broken in 1973 and 1977
 - 1993: curtailed to seniormost only
- Judges Cases
 - 1981: exchange of views
 - 1993: concurrence
 - 1998: collegium of 4 judges
 - 2015: NJAC struck down
- NJAC composition
 - CJI as chairperson
 - Two seniormost judges and Law Minister
 - Two eminent persons

Jurisdiction and Temporary Appointments

The Supreme Court has appellate, original and advisory jurisdiction. Article 32 allows direct approach for violation of Fundamental Rights, while the President can seek an advisory opinion under Article 143 that is not binding. Articles 126, 127 and 128 allow an Acting CJI, ad hoc judges and retired judges in specified situations.

- Appellate jurisdiction covers appeals against lower court judgments
- Appeals from High Courts need a certificate under Article 134A
- Article 131 gives original jurisdiction in certain disputes
- Article 32: direct approach for violation of Fundamental Rights
- Article 143: President may seek advisory opinion on public importance questions
- Advisory opinion is NOT binding on the President
- Article 126: Acting CJI appointed when CJI post is vacant or absent
- Article 127: CJI can appoint a High Court judge as ad hoc judge for lack of quorum
- Article 127 needs prior consent of the President
- Article 128: retired SC or HC judge can be requested to sit, with consent

Mnemonic - Temporary Appointments Order: Always Accept Retirees

Always (Art 126) = Acting CJI from SC judges when CJI post is vacant or absent; Accept (Art 127) = Ad hoc judge from High Court judges for lack of quorum; Retirees (Art 128) = Retired SC or HC judge can be requested to sit

Mind-map outline

SC Jurisdiction and Temporary Posts

- Jurisdictions
 - Appellate: appeals from lower courts
 - Original: Article 131 and Article 32
 - Advisory: Article 143, not binding
- Temporary appointments
 - Article 126: Acting CJI
 - Article 127: ad hoc judge
 - Article 128: retired judges

Anti-Defection Law

Origin and Objective

The Anti-Defection Law was introduced through the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1985, and placed in the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution. Its objective is to prevent political defections and ensure stability in governments. The phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' is linked to frequent party-switching by legislators in the 1960s. The law applies to both Parliament and State Assemblies.

- Introduced through the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1985
- Enshrined in the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution
- Objective: prevent political defections and ensure stability in governments
- Phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' linked to frequent party-switching in the 1960s
- Applies to both Parliament and State Legislatures
- Constitutional basis: Articles 102(1) and 191(1)
- Lays down the process for disqualifying legislators on grounds of defection

Mind-map outline

Origin and Objective

- Introduced by 52nd CAA, 1985
 - Placed in Tenth Schedule
- Phrase: Aaya Ram Gaya Ram
 - Linked to 1960s party-switching
- Objective
 - Prevent political defections
 - Ensure stability in governments
- Applies to Parliament and State Assemblies

Grounds for Disqualification

A legislator loses membership if they voluntarily give up party membership or vote or abstain contrary to the party whip. Under Articles 102(1) and 191(1), a legislator can also be disqualified for holding an office of profit, being declared of unsound mind by a court, being an undischarged insolvent, losing Indian citizenship or showing allegiance to another country, or being disqualified under any law made by Parliament. The booklet also lists joining another party and opposing party direction as grounds in the disqualification summary.

- Voluntarily giving up party membership is a ground for disqualification
- Voting or abstaining contrary to the party whip is a ground for disqualification
- Holding an office of profit is a ground under Articles 102(1) and 191(1)
- Being declared of unsound mind by a court is a ground
- Being an undischarged insolvent is a ground
- Losing Indian citizenship or showing allegiance to another country is a ground
- Disqualification under any law made by Parliament is a ground

Mnemonic - Grounds under Articles 102(1) and 191(1): Please Use Its Clear Logic

P = Office of profit; U = Declared of unsound mind by a court; I = Undischarged insolvent; C = Lost citizenship or showing allegiance to another country; L = Disqualified under any law made by Parliament

Mind-map outline

Grounds for Disqualification

- Voluntary conduct
 - Gives up party membership
 - Votes or abstains against whip
- Articles 102(1) and 191(1)
 - Office of profit
 - Declared of unsound mind
 - Undischarged insolvent
 - Lost citizenship or allegiance abroad
- Other law
 - Disqualified under a law made by Parliament

Exceptions, Mergers and Member Categories

A party can merge without disqualification if two-thirds of the members of a legislature party agree, a provision retained after the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003. That amendment removed the earlier split provision, under which one-third of members could split without disqualification. A whip breach is excused if prior permission is taken or the party condones the action within 15 days. Independent members are disqualified for joining a party after election, while nominated members are disqualified for joining after six months of nomination.

- Merger: no disqualification if two-thirds of a legislature party agree to merge
- Earlier, one-third of members could split without disqualification
- The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003) removed the split provision
- Whip exception: prior permission taken, or party condones the action within 15 days
- Independent member: disqualified if they join a party after election
- Nominated member: disqualified if they join a party after six months of nomination
- Merger provision is an exception to disqualification under the law

Mnemonic - Merger versus split: Two thirds merge, splits gone

Two thirds merge = Two-thirds of a legislature party can merge without disqualification; Splits gone = The one-third split provision was removed by the 91st CAA, 2003

Mind-map outline

Exceptions and Member Categories

- Merger
 - Two-thirds of legislature party
 - No disqualification on merger
- Split provision
 - Earlier: one-third could split
 - Removed by 91st CAA, 2003

- Whip exception
 - Prior permission taken
 - Party condones within 15 days
- Member categories
 - Independent: joins party after election
 - Nominated: joins party after 6 months

Deciding Authority and Judicial Review

The Speaker (Lok Sabha) or the Chairman (Rajya Sabha) decides disqualification petitions, and the decision is subject to judicial review. *Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)* says such decisions should ideally be made within 3 months. The grounds for reviewing a Speaker's decision, laid down in *Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil vs Speaker Karnataka (2019)*, include violation of a constitutional mandate, malafide intent, a perverse decision, and failure to follow natural justice.

- Speaker (Lok Sabha) or Chairman (Rajya Sabha) decides disqualification
- Decision of the Speaker or Chairman is subject to judicial review
- *Kihoto Hollohan vs Zachillhu (1992)*: Speaker's decisions subject to judicial review
- *Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)*: decisions ideally within 3 months
- *Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil vs Speaker Karnataka (2019)*: review grounds include malafide intent and perverse decision
- *Ravi S Naik vs Union of India*: membership can be inferred from members' conduct

Mind-map outline

Deciding Authority and Review

- Who decides
 - Speaker (Lok Sabha)
 - Chairman (Rajya Sabha)
- Review
 - Decisions subject to judicial review
 - Malafide intent or perverse decision
 - Violates constitutional mandate or natural justice
- Judgments
 - *Keisham (2020)*: ideally 3 months
 - *Ravi S Naik*: membership inferred from conduct

Significance, Criticisms and Key Issues

The law allows party mergers without disqualifying members, prevents defections for office or material gain, and supports party stability and discipline. Critics point to long delays in deciding disqualification petitions, allegations that presiding officers act partisanly, and limited judicial intervention before the Speaker decides. They also argue that the two-thirds merger clause enables mass defections and that the rigid whip system reduces intra-party democracy.

- Prevents defections for office or material gain
- Ensures party stability and prevents government instability
- Ensures party discipline through adherence to the whip
- Makes legislators accountable for their conduct
- Key issue: disqualification petitions often remain pending for long durations
- Key issue: allegations of bias, as Speaker or Chairman may act partisanly
- Key issue: courts typically intervene only after the Speaker's decision
- Key issue: rigid whip system, including whips on non-critical matters
- Key issue: two-thirds merger clause enables large-scale defections

Mind-map outline

Significance and Key Issues

- Significance
 - Prevents defection for office or gain
 - Ensures party stability and discipline
 - Makes legislators accountable
- Key issues
 - Delay in deciding petitions

- Speaker bias allegations
- Limited judicial intervention
- Rigid whip system
- Two-thirds clause enables mass defections

Economics

India's Forex Stress and Call for Economic Austerity

Forex Reserves: Decline and Role

India's forex reserves fell by nearly USD 38 billion within two months, reaching around USD 691 billion by May 2026. The reserves are external assets held by the RBI and act as a buffer against external shocks. They strengthen when inflows exceed outflows and weaken when outflows rise.

- Reserves declined by nearly USD 38 billion within two months, to about USD 691 billion by May 2026
- Three triggers cited: volatile oil prices, record-breaking gold imports, RBI intervention to defend the rupee
- Forex reserves are external assets maintained by the Reserve Bank of India
- Components: foreign currency assets, gold reserves, Special Drawing Rights, reserve position with the IMF
- Inflows exceeding outflows strengthen reserves and support rupee stability
- Rising outflows or falling foreign investment can reduce reserves and depreciate the rupee
- Reserves ensure uninterrupted access to crude oil, fertilisers and industrial machinery
- Reserves act as a shield against global instability and sudden capital outflows
- Lower reserves mean a reduced buffer and higher sensitivity to global capital flows

Mnemonic - Reserve components: Forex Gold Stays Reserved

F = Foreign currency assets; G = Gold reserves; S = Special Drawing Rights; R = Reserve position with the IMF

Mind-map outline

Forex Reserves

- Components
 - Foreign currency assets
 - Gold reserves
 - Special Drawing Rights
 - Reserve position with IMF
- Rise and fall
 - Inflows exceed outflows: reserves strengthen
 - Outflows rise: reserves shrink, rupee weakens
- Role
 - Buffer against external shocks
 - Shield against sudden capital outflows

Import Pressures: Oil, Gold and Fertiliser

India's current account deficit is widened by heavy reliance on imported crude oil, record gold purchases and costly fertiliser inputs. Each of these imports draws on dollar reserves and adds pressure on the rupee. The booklet links this to a persistent CAD and imported inflation.

- India imports around 89% of its crude oil requirement
- Every USD 1 rise in oil price adds USD 1.5 to 2 billion to the import bill
- India is the 2nd largest gold consumer globally, after China
- Gold accounts for nearly USD 72 billion, about 9% of total imports
- Household gold imports do not add to productive capacity and directly worsen the CAD
- Imported inputs such as urea and ammonia prices have doubled
- Oil marketing companies face under-recoveries because retail fuel prices are frozen
- Rupee depreciation raises import costs, which push up domestic prices
- Persistent CAD reflects inelastic import demand and dependence on external financing

Mind-map outline

Import Pressures

- Crude oil
 - About 89% of requirement imported
 - USD 1 oil rise adds USD 1.5-2 bn
- Gold
 - 2nd largest consumer after China
 - About 9% of total imports
 - Does not add to productive capacity
- Fertiliser
 - Urea and ammonia prices doubled
 - Passing costs: inflation risk
 - Absorbing costs: fiscal deficit risk
- Currency loop
 - Rupee depreciation raises import cost
 - Higher import cost lifts domestic prices

Why the Government Seeks Austerity

The Prime Minister has urged citizens to limit non-essential spending on gold, overseas travel and fuel. The aims are to manage the CAD, stabilise the rupee and contain capital flight. The approach shifts from supply-side diversification to demand-side restraint.

- PM urged citizens to reduce non-essential spending on gold, overseas travel and fuel
- Cutting non-essential imports helps conserve foreign exchange
- Demand-side measures include work-from-home, carpooling and virtual meetings
- Surging fertiliser prices push government to prioritise food security over discretionary fuel use
- Austerity aims to curb capital flight and reduce forex outflows
- Strategic autonomy: shift from supply-side diversification to demand-side restraint
- Goal: reduce dependence on volatile regions and lower energy-to-GDP sensitivity
- Aim: strengthen resilience against global shocks

Mind-map outline

Why Austerity

- Forex and rupee
 - Conserve forex via non-essential imports
 - Manage CAD and rupee stability
- Capital flight
 - Curb capital flight
 - Reduce forex outflows
- Energy and food
 - Fertiliser surge forces policy shift
 - Food security over discretionary fuel
- Strategic shift
 - Demand-side restraint over supply-side diversification
 - Lower energy-to-GDP sensitivity

Costs of Excessive Forex Conservation

The booklet cautions that overly strict controls could stifle manufacturing, weaken exports and discourage foreign investment. Suppressing private consumption also threatens aggregate demand and job creation. Past import-substitution attempts are cited as a warning, since they led to low competitiveness.

- Indian industry depends on imported capital goods, semiconductors and raw materials
- Restricted imports lower industrial output and exports
- Protectionism trap: import curbs raise input costs and reduce export competitiveness
- Capital control concerns raise the country risk premium
- Foreign direct and portfolio investment inflows could be dampened
- Private consumption is a major GDP component; reducing it weakens growth
- Foreign investors avoid economies lacking strong domestic demand
- Past import-substitution efforts led to low industrial competitiveness and inefficiency
- Lower production leads to significantly reduced job creation

Mnemonic - Costs of over-restraint: Most People Ignore Dull Economics

M = Manufacturing: restricted imports lower industrial output; P = Protectionism trap: import curbs raise input costs; I = Investment: FDI and portfolio inflows may be dampened; D = Demand: private consumption is a major GDP component; E = Employment: lower production reduces job creation

Mind-map outline

Costs of Forex Conservation

- Industry
 - Imported capital goods and semiconductors
 - Restricted imports lower output
 - Protectionism trap raises input costs
- Investment
 - Higher country risk premium
 - Lower FDI and portfolio inflows
- Demand and jobs
 - Private consumption is major GDP component
 - Lower production cuts job creation
- Past lesson
 - Import substitution led to low competitiveness

Summits, Reports, Indices

World Press Freedom Index 2026

Index Overview and Methodology

The World Press Freedom Index is an annual report published by Reporters Without Borders (RSF), a non-profit organisation with headquarters in Paris. It has been published annually since 2002, and the 2026 edition is the 24th. The Index ranks 180 countries and regions on the level of freedom available to journalists, using a Press Freedom Questionnaire with five categories. Each country receives a score from 0 (worst) to 100 (best).

- Published by Reporters Without Borders (RSF), a non-profit organisation
- RSF was founded in 1985 and has its headquarters in Paris, France
- Annual report since 2002; the 2026 edition is the 24th
- Ranks 180 countries and regions by freedom available to journalists
- Evaluates pluralism, media independence, legal framework and journalist safety
- Press Freedom Questionnaire covers 5 categories
- Each country gets a score from 0 (worst) to 100 (best)
- Aim: safeguarding the right to freedom of information

Mind-map outline

Index Overview and Methodology

- Publisher: RSF
 - Founded 1985
 - HQ Paris
- Coverage
 - Annual since 2002
 - 180 countries and regions
- Scoring
 - 0 worst to 100 best
 - 5 questionnaire categories
- Aim
 - Safeguarding freedom of information

Key Findings and Country Rankings 2026

The 2026 Index finds that global press freedom has declined, with 52.2 per cent of countries rated 'Difficult' or 'Very Serious' for journalism. Only 1 per cent of the world's population lives in countries rated 'Good'. Norway remains top-ranked, while Syria recorded the sharpest rise after its political transition and Niger the steepest fall. The Middle East and North Africa remained the most dangerous region for journalists.

- Global press freedom declines; a majority of countries (52.2%) face Difficult or Very Serious conditions

- Only 1% of the population lives in countries rated 'Good' for journalism
- Norway is top-ranked for the 10th consecutive year, with a score of 92.72
- Top-ranked order: Norway, Netherlands, Estonia, Denmark, Sweden
- Netherlands scored 88.92 and was ranked second on the score list
- Bottom-ranked countries named: Eritrea, North Korea, China, Iran, Saudi Arabia
- Legal indicator saw the sharpest decline, due to criminalisation of journalism and misuse of laws
- Middle East and North Africa remained the most dangerous region for journalists
- Syria rose sharply in rankings after its political transition
- Niger suffered the steepest ranking fall (120th) due to military rule and armed group violence in the Sahel
- India ranked 157th with a score of 31.96 ('Very Serious') in 2026, from 151st in 2025

Mind-map outline

Key Findings and Rankings 2026

- Global trend
 - 52.2% countries Difficult or Very Serious
 - Only 1% population in Good countries
 - Legal indicator: sharpest decline
- Top ranked
 - Norway: 10th consecutive year
 - Score 92.72
 - Netherlands second, 88.92
- Bottom ranked
 - Eritrea, North Korea, China
 - Iran, Saudi Arabia
- Major movers
 - Syria: sharpest rise
 - Niger: steepest fall
 - India: 157th, from 151st
- Regions
 - Middle East and North Africa most dangerous

Challenges and Significance of a Free Press

Media in 160 of the 180 countries face financial instability, which threatens independent and unbiased reporting, and political instability is linked to declining media freedom. A free press is often described as the fourth pillar of democracy, giving voice to marginalised communities and sparking debate that can lead to reform. During the pandemic, media acted as a critical communication tool between governments and citizens. Under the Indian Constitution, press freedom flows from Article 19(1)(a) but remains subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2).

- Media in 160 of 180 countries face financial instability
- Political instability is linked to decline in media freedom
- Press is often called the 4th pillar of democracy, alongside legislature, judiciary and executive
- Press acts as a bridge between the governed and the governing, especially for marginalised communities
- Press sparks public debate, a precursor to legislative and social reform
- During the pandemic, media was a critical communication tool between government and citizens
- Freedom of press is treated as part of freedom of speech under Article 19(1)(a)
- Article 19(2) allows reasonable restrictions, including on defamation, contempt of court and public order
- Freedom of media is not an absolute freedom
- In *Romesh Thappar vs State of Madras (1950)*, the Supreme Court said freedom of press lies at the foundation of all democratic organisations

Mind-map outline

Challenges and Significance

- Challenges
 - Financial instability: 160 of 180
 - Political instability linked to decline

- Role of press
 - Fourth pillar of democracy
 - Bridge: governed and governing
 - Sparks debate and reform
- Pandemic role
 - Critical communication tool
 - Fought misinformation
- Constitution
 - Article 19(1)(a): freedom of speech
 - Article 19(2): reasonable restrictions

History and Institutions of Press Freedom in India

Printing in India expanded under European trading companies, and India's first newspaper, the Bengal Gazette, appeared in 1780. Colonial measures such as the Censorship of Press Act 1799 and the Vernacular Press Act 1878 restricted the press, while Metcalfe's Press Act 1835 is remembered as the liberator of the Indian press. Today, the Press Council of India, set up under the Press Council Act 1978, and the Editors Guild of India work to uphold press freedom and journalistic standards.

- East India Company set up its first printing press in Bombay in 1674
- James Augustus Hickey's Bengal Gazette, India's first newspaper, was published in 1780
- Censorship of Press Act 1799, issued by Lord Wellesley, curbed French propaganda against British rule
- Raja Rammohan Roy founded the Bengali weekly Sambad Kaumudi (1821) to champion social reform
- Bombay Samachar (1822), India's oldest running vernacular newspaper, was founded by Fardoonji Murazban
- Metcalfe's Press Act 1835 is known as the liberator of the Indian press
- Vernacular Press Act 1878, proposed by Lord Lytton, was enacted to suppress press freedom and criticism of British rule
- Press Council of India was initially established in 1966 under the Indian Press Council Act 1965
- Press Council of India was abolished in 1975 during the Emergency, after repeal of the 1965 Act
- Press Council of India was established in 1978 as a statutory quasi-judicial body under the Press Council Act 1978

Mnemonic - Press Council of India timeline: Sixty-Six Born, Seventy-Five Torn, Seventy-Eight Reborn
 1966 = Initially established under the Indian Press Council Act 1965; 1975 = Abolished during the Emergency after repeal of the 1965 Act; 1978 = Established as a statutory quasi-judicial body under the Press Council Act 1978

Mind-map outline

History and Institutions in India

- Early press
 - EIC press in Bombay, 1674
 - Bengal Gazette, 1780
- Early weeklies
 - Sambad Kaumudi, 1821
 - Bombay Samachar, 1822
- Colonial laws
 - Censorship of Press Act, 1799
 - Vernacular Press Act, 1878
- Liberator of the press
 - Metcalfe's Press Act, 1835
- Institutions
 - Press Council of India: 1966, 1975, 1978
 - Editors Guild of India, 1978

LEADS 2025 Report

LEADS Index Basics

LEADS stands for Logistics Ease Across Different States and is India's national index for benchmarking logistics performance across States and UTs. It was launched in 2018 and draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade prepares the report, and the 7th LEADS 2025 Report introduced a four-tier classification in place of the earlier three-tier model.

- LEADS stands for Logistics Ease Across Different States.
- LEADS is India's national index benchmarking logistics performance across States and UTs.
- LEADS was launched in 2018.
- LEADS draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index.
- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (Ministry of Commerce and Industry) prepares the LEADS Report.
- The Department released the 7th LEADS 2025 Report.
- The LEADS 2025 edition introduced a four-tier classification replacing the earlier three-tier model.
- States and UTs are evaluated across key logistics parameters, including infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment and data-driven logistics reforms.
- The LEADS 2025 Report is presented across 13 logistics-related categories.
- LEAPS stands for Logistics Excellence, Advancement and Performance Shield.

Mind-map outline

LEADS Index Basics

- Name and purpose
 - Logistics Ease Across Different States
 - Benchmarks States and UTs
- Timeline and preparer
 - Launched in 2018
 - Prepared by DPIIT
- 2025 edition changes
 - 7th LEADS 2025 Report
 - Four-tier replaces three-tier
 - Presented across 13 categories
- Global inspiration
 - World Bank Logistics Performance Index

State and UT Categories in LEADS 2025

The LEADS 2025 edition sorts States and UTs into four categories: Exemplars, High Performers, Accelerators and Growth-Seekers. Each entry carries a regional tag of Coastal, Landlocked, North-East (N-E) or UTs. Uttar Pradesh became an Exemplar after being an Achiever from 2022 to 2024, and Jammu and Kashmir moved from Fast Mover to High Performer.

- The 2025 edition introduced four new categories: Exemplars, High Performers, Accelerators and Growth-Seekers.
- Exemplars (4): Tamil Nadu (Coastal), Uttar Pradesh (Landlocked), Mizoram (N-E) and Delhi (UTs).
- Uttar Pradesh achieved Exemplar status after being categorised as an Achiever from 2022 to 2024.
- High Performers (11): Gujarat (Coastal), Haryana (Landlocked), Tripura (N-E) and Jammu and Kashmir (UTs).
- Jammu and Kashmir improved from Fast Mover in 2024 to High Performer in 2025.
- Accelerators (17) include Andhra Pradesh (Coastal), Punjab (Landlocked) and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu (UTs).
- Growth-Seekers (4): West Bengal (Coastal), Rajasthan (Landlocked), Sikkim (N-E) and Andaman and Nicobar Islands (UTs).
- The regional tags used in the report are Coastal, Landlocked, N-E (North-East) and UTs.

Mnemonic - Four State and UT categories: Every Hero Accelerates Growth

E = Exemplars (4 States and UTs); H = High Performers (11 States and UTs); A = Accelerators (17 States and UTs); G = Growth-Seekers (4 States and UTs)

Mind-map outline

State and UT Categories 2025

- Exemplars (4)

- Tamil Nadu (Coastal)
- Uttar Pradesh (Landlocked)
- Mizoram (N-E)
- Delhi (UTs)
- High Performers (11)
 - Gujarat (Coastal)
 - Haryana (Landlocked)
 - Tripura (N-E)
 - Jammu and Kashmir (UTs)
- Accelerators (17)
 - Andhra Pradesh (Coastal)
 - Punjab (Landlocked)
 - Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu (UTs)
- Growth-Seekers (4)
 - West Bengal (Coastal)
 - Rajasthan (Landlocked)
 - Sikkim (N-E)
 - Andaman and Nicobar Islands (UTs)

National Logistics Initiatives and the World Bank LPI

Several national programmes aim to strengthen logistics, including the National Logistics Policy 2022, PM GatiShakti, Bharatmala Pariyojana, Sagarmala and the E-Way Bill System. India's logistics performance is also tracked globally through the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index. That index has six key dimensions and is reported by the World Bank every two years.

- The National Logistics Policy 2022 aims to lower the cost of logistics to par with other developed countries.
- Logistics costs in India remain relatively high at around 7.97% of GDP.
- The PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021 promotes integrated planning across roads, railways, ports, airports and logistics networks.
- The Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme aims to enhance freight speed, reduce costs and improve tracking.
- Bharatmala Pariyojana aims to improve road connectivity across India.
- The Sagarmala Programme focuses on port-led development and boosts coastal shipping efficiency.
- The E-Way Bill System mandates digital bills for goods, easing inter-state transport.
- The Logistics Performance Index has six key dimensions, including customs performance, infrastructure quality and timeliness of shipments.
- India ranked 38th among 139 countries in the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index 2023.
- The World Bank reports the Logistics Performance Index every 2 years.

Mnemonic - Six LPI dimensions: Can Ice Elephants Lift Trucks Today

C = Customs Performance; I = Infrastructure Quality; E = Ease of Arranging Shipments; L = Logistics Services Quality; T = Tracking and Tracing of consignments; T = Timeliness of Shipments

Mind-map outline

Logistics Initiatives and LPI

- Policy frameworks
 - National Logistics Policy 2022
 - PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021
- Transport connectivity
 - Bharatmala Pariyojana: road connectivity
 - Sagarmala: port-led development
- Efficiency and documents
 - Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme
 - E-Way Bill System for goods
- Global benchmark
 - LPI: six key dimensions
 - India ranked 38th of 139 (2023)

Dedicated Freight Corridors

Dedicated Freight Corridors are exclusive freight tracks, implemented under the Ministry of Railways by DFCCIL, that use double-stack and heavy-haul trains for high capacity and speed. They aim to reduce logistics costs, have improved port access and have contributed to Indian Railways' revenue growth. Under the National Rail Plan they are expected to raise rail's share of freight, while delays in the Western corridor added to project costs.

- Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFCs) are exclusive freight tracks that support double-stack and heavy-haul trains with high capacity and speed.
- DFCs fall under the Ministry of Railways, and the Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India (DFCCIL) is the implementing agency.
- A key objective of DFCs is to reduce logistics costs below 10% as per the National Logistics Policy.
- The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC) has improved port access and lowered transit times.
- DFCs have generated jobs, attracted investments and aided economic growth.
- DFCs have contributed to Indian Railways' revenue growth for FY 2018-19 to FY 2022-23.
- Under the National Rail Plan, DFCs aim to boost rail freight's share to 45% by 2030.
- The North-South DFC runs from Vijayawada to Itarsi and is 975 km long.
- The East Coast DFC runs from Kharagpur to Vijayawada and is 1115 km long.
- Delays in completing the final section of the WDFC added to project costs.

Mind-map outline

Dedicated Freight Corridors

- Design
 - Exclusive freight tracks
 - Double-stack and heavy-haul trains
- Agency and aim
 - DFCCIL under Ministry of Railways
 - Reduce logistics costs below 10%
- Impact
 - Better port access (WDFC)
 - Jobs and investment
 - Rail freight share 45% by 2030
- Challenges
 - Delays in WDFC final section
 - Higher project costs

Sports, Awards & Days

National Technology Day 2026

Origin and observance of National Technology Day

National Technology Day is observed on 11 May each year. It was declared by PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee in 1998 to commemorate technological achievements of 11 May 1998, and has been observed annually from 1999 onward. The 2026 observance carried the theme 'Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth'.

- National Technology Day is observed on 11 May every year.
- PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee declared 11 May as National Technology Day in 1998.
- It has been observed annually as National Technology Day from 1999 onward.
- It commemorates major technological achievements of 11 May 1998.
- The 2026 observance theme was 'Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth'.
- On 11 May 1998, Pokhran-II nuclear tests (Operation Shakti) were conducted.
- On the same day, Hansa-3 completed its first successful test flight.
- On the same day, DRDO successfully test-fired the Trishul short-range surface-to-air missile.
- Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar awards are announced annually on National Technology Day.

Mnemonic - Start of the day: Ninety-Eight declared, Ninety-Nine began

Ninety-Eight = Declared by PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee in 1998; Ninety-Nine = Observed annually as National Technology Day from 1999 onward

Mind-map outline

National Technology Day

- Date: 11 May
 - Observed every year
- Declared 1998
 - PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- Observed from 1999
 - Annually onward
- 2026 theme
 - Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth

Pokhran nuclear tests (1974 and 1998)

India conducted a series of nuclear tests at the Pokhran Test Range in Rajasthan's Thar Desert in May 1998, under the codename Shakti. The series began on 11 May with three tests and was followed on 13 May by two more. These were the first confirmed nuclear detonations since the 1974 Pokhran-I test, codenamed 'Smiling Buddha'.

- Pokhran-I, India's first nuclear test, was conducted on 18 May 1974.
- Pokhran-I was codenamed 'Smiling Buddha'.
- Pokhran-II was a series of nuclear tests conducted by India in May 1998 at Pokhran Test Range.
- The Pokhran Test Range is in Rajasthan's Thar Desert.
- On 11 May 1998, India conducted three nuclear tests under the codename Shakti.
- On 13 May 1998, India conducted two more nuclear tests.
- Pokhran-II marked India's first confirmed nuclear detonations since the 1974 'Peaceful Nuclear Explosion'.
- Operation Shakti marks India's emergence as a nuclear weapons state.
- India became the 6th country to join the nuclear club.
- Abdul Kalam and R. Chidambaram were the chief coordinators of Pokhran-II.

Mnemonic - Pokhran-II test counts: Eleven Three, Thirteen Two

Eleven Three = 11 May 1998: three nuclear tests under the codename Shakti; Thirteen Two = 13 May 1998: two more nuclear tests

Mind-map outline

Pokhran nuclear tests

- Pokhran-I
 - Codename: Smiling Buddha
 - 18 May 1974
- Pokhran-II, 11 May 1998
 - Three tests
 - Codename: Shakti
- Pokhran-II, 13 May 1998
 - Two more tests
- Outcomes
 - Nuclear weapons state
 - 6th country in nuclear club

Space and defence milestones

India's space and defence milestones include lunar, Mars and solar missions, along with indigenous naval and air platforms. Chandrayaan-3 achieved a soft landing near the Moon's South Pole, a global first. Upcoming missions include Gaganyaan (2027) as the first crewed spaceflight and Shukrayaan (2028) as a Venus orbiter.

- Chandrayaan-1 (2008) was India's first lunar mission and discovered water on the Moon.
- Mangalyaan (2013) was India's first successful Mars mission, achieved on its first attempt.
- In 2017, 104 satellites were launched in one launch, a world record.
- Chandrayaan-3 (2023) achieved a soft landing near the Moon's South Pole, a global first.
- Aditya-L1 (2023) is India's first solar mission.
- Gaganyaan (2027) is the upcoming first crewed spaceflight.
- Shukrayaan (2028) is the upcoming Venus Orbiter Mission.
- INS Kalvari (1967) was India's first indigenous submarine.

- INS Arihant is India's first ballistic missile nuclear submarine.
- INS Vikrant (2022) is India's first indigenous aircraft carrier.
- Tejas (LCA) is an indigenous supersonic fighter jet.

Mnemonic - Chandrayaan milestones: One finds water, Three lands at the Pole

One = Chandrayaan-1 (2008) discovered water on the Moon; Three = Chandrayaan-3 (2023) achieved a soft landing near the Moon's South Pole

Mind-map outline

Space and defence milestones

- Lunar
 - Chandrayaan-1 (2008): water found
 - Chandrayaan-3 (2023): South Pole landing
- Mars and solar
 - Mangalyaan (2013)
 - Aditya-L1 (2023)
- Upcoming
 - Gaganyaan (2027)
 - Shukrayaan (2028)
- Naval and air
 - INS Kalvari (1967)
 - INS Arihant, INS Vikrant (2022)
 - Tejas and BrahMos

Digital, farm and ranking milestones

The day also highlights India's digital infrastructure and farm milestones. Aadhaar and UPI are cited as major digital achievements, while the Green and White Revolutions transformed agriculture and dairy. India's standing in the Global Innovation Index 2026 and other rankings completes the picture.

- Aadhaar is the world's largest biometric ID system.
- UPI (Unified Payments Interface) revolutionised digital payments.
- The Green Revolution boosted production with high-yielding wheat and rice varieties.
- The White Revolution made India the world's largest milk producer.
- India was ranked 38th globally in the Global Innovation Index 2026.
- India holds 6th position worldwide in intellectual property filings (WIPO report).
- India ranks as the 3rd largest startup ecosystem globally.

Mind-map outline

Digital, farm and rankings

- Digital
 - Aadhaar: largest biometric ID
 - UPI: digital payments
- Farm
 - Green Revolution: wheat and rice
 - White Revolution: largest milk producer
- Rankings
 - GII 2026: 38th globally
 - IP filings: 6th (WIPO)
 - Startup ecosystem: 3rd largest

Institutions, schemes and awards

Several bodies and schemes support technology in India. The Technology Development Board is a statutory body that promotes the commercialisation of indigenous technology. The Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar awards, India's science honours, are announced on National Technology Day.

- The Technology Development Board is a statutory body under the Technology Development Board Act, 1995.
- The TDB promotes development and commercialisation of indigenous technology.
- The TDB also supports adaptation of imported technology for wider application.
- The TDB provides financial assistance to commercialise indigenous technologies.
- Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar is India's science honour, comparable to the Padma Awards.

- Atal Innovation Mission, launched by NITI Aayog, fosters an innovation culture.
- Atal Tinkering Labs are innovation labs in schools; Atal Incubation Centres support startups.
- NM-ICPS promotes R&D in AI, Robotics, IoT, Quantum Computing and related fields.
- The National Quantum Mission focuses on quantum computing, communication, sensing and materials.
- iDEX (Innovations for Defence Excellence) promotes indigenous defence startups and MSMEs.

Mind-map outline

Institutions, schemes and awards

- Statutory body
 - Technology Development Board (1995 Act)
- Awards
 - Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar
- Innovation schemes
 - Atal Innovation Mission (NITI Aayog)
 - Atal Tinkering Labs in schools
 - Atal Incubation Centres for startups
- Missions
 - NM-ICPS: AI, robotics, IoT, quantum
 - National Quantum Mission
 - National Supercomputing Mission
- Defence and science
 - iDEX for defence startups
 - INSPIRE (DST) scholarships

International Labour Day

Origin of International Labour Day

International Labour Day, also called Workers Day or May Day, is observed every year on May 1 to honour the contribution of workers. Its origin is traced to the late 19th century labour movement in the United States, where workers demanded an eight-hour working day. A large 1886 demonstration in Chicago went out of hand, and the incident known as the Haymarket Affair marked the start of the day. In 1889, Socialist Parties in Europe decided to celebrate May 1 as International Labour Day.

- Observed annually on May 1
- Also known as Workers Day or May Day
- Origin traced to the late 19th century labour movement in the United States
- 1886: large demonstration in America demanded 8 hours of work on a daily basis
- The 1886 demonstration went out of hand in Chicago and many people got hurt
- The incident is known as the Haymarket Affair
- Haymarket Affair marked the start of International Labour Day
- 1889: Socialist Parties in Europe decided to celebrate May 1 as International Labour Day
- 1923: first May Day in India celebrated in Chennai (then Madras)
- The 1923 celebration was by the Labour Kisan Party of Hindustan

Mind-map outline

Origin of International Labour Day

- 1886 US demonstration
 - Demand: 8 hours of work daily
 - Went out of hand in Chicago
- Haymarket Affair
 - Marked start of the day
- 1889 European Socialist Parties
 - Decided to observe May 1
- 1923 India
 - First May Day in Chennai

Constitutional provisions and labour laws

The Constitution gives citizens the right to form associations or unions and prohibits forced labour and employment of children below 14 years. Articles 39(a), 41, 43 and 43A set out goals for the State on livelihood, work, a living wage and worker participation in management. Labour legislation includes laws on factories, wages, provident funds and industrial disputes. Four labour codes together amalgamate 29 laws.

- Article 19(1)(c): right to form associations or unions
- Article 23: prohibits forced labour
- Article 24: prohibits employment of children below 14 years
- Article 39(a): equal right to an adequate means of livelihood
- Article 41: right to work and education within limits of economic capacity
- Article 43: living wage, decent conditions of work, social and cultural opportunities
- Article 43A: participation of workers in management of industries through legislation
- Factories Act 1948; Minimum Wages Act 1948; Payment of Wages Act 1936; Workmen's Compensation Act 1923
- Employees' Provident Fund Act 1952; Industrial Disputes Act 1947; Contract Labour Act 1970
- Four codes amalgamate 29 laws in total: Wage Code 4, Industrial Relations Code 3, Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code 13, Social Security Code 9

Mind-map outline

Constitution and labour laws

- Rights and bans
 - Art 19(1)(c): form unions
 - Art 23: forced labour banned
 - Art 24: child labour under 14 banned
- Goals for the State
 - Art 39(a): livelihood
 - Art 41: right to work and education
 - Art 43: living wage
 - Art 43A: worker participation
- Labour codes
 - 29 laws in four codes

International Labour Organisation: profile

The International Labour Organisation is a specialised agency of the United Nations dedicated to improving labour conditions and living standards throughout the world. It was established under the Treaty of Versailles and became the first specialised agency associated with the UN in 1946. Its tripartite structure gives an equal voice to governments, employers and workers. The ILO was awarded the Nobel Prize for Peace in 1969, and its headquarters is in Geneva, Switzerland.

- Specialised agency of the United Nations
- Dedicated to improving labour conditions and living standards throughout the world
- Established under the Treaty of Versailles
- Became the first specialised agency associated with the UN in 1946, after the demise of the League of Nations
- Tripartite structure: equal voice for governments, employers and workers
- India is one of the founding members
- Awarded the Nobel Prize for Peace in 1969
- Director General: Gilbert Hounghbo
- Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland

Mnemonic - ILO structure: GEW: Give Equal Weight

G = Governments; E = Employers; W = Workers

Mind-map outline

ILO profile

- Establishment
 - Treaty of Versailles
 - UN agency since 1946

- Structure
 - Tripartite: governments, employers, workers
 - India a founding member
- Recognition and leadership
 - Nobel Peace Prize 1969
 - DG: Gilbert Hounbo
 - HQ: Geneva, Switzerland

ILO objectives, standards and reports

The ILO pursues four stated objectives: promoting fundamental labour rights, creating greater opportunities for women and men, enhancing social protection, and strengthening social dialogue and tripartism. Its international labour standards are Conventions and Protocols, which are legally binding treaties, and Recommendations, which are non-binding guidelines. The ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, adopted in 1998, names focus areas such as freedom of association and abolition of child labour. The ILO also publishes key reports, including the Global Wage Report.

- Objective: promote and realise standard fundamental labour rights
- Objective: create greater opportunities for women and men
- Objective: enhance social protection
- Objective: strengthen social dialogue and tripartism
- Conventions and Protocols: legally binding international treaties
- Recommendations: non-binding guidelines
- ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work: adopted in 1998, amended in 2022
- Focus areas: freedom of association, elimination of forced labour, abolition of child labour, elimination of employment discrimination, safe and healthy working conditions
- Fundamental conventions listed include Minimum Age (No. 138) and Freedom of Association (No. 87)
- Key reports include World Employment and Social Outlook, Global Wage Report, World Social Protection Report and World of Work Report

Mnemonic - ILO objectives: Pretty Cats Eat Shrimp

P = Promote fundamental labour rights; C = Create greater opportunities for women and men; E = Enhance social protection; S = Strengthen social dialogue and tripartism

Mind-map outline

ILO objectives and standards

- Four objectives
 - Fundamental labour rights
 - Opportunities for women and men
 - Enhanced social protection
 - Social dialogue and tripartism
- International standards
 - Conventions and Protocols: binding
 - Recommendations: non-binding
- 1998 Declaration
 - Focus: freedom of association
 - Focus: abolition of child labour
- Key reports
 - Global Wage Report
 - World Employment and Social Outlook

Miscellaneous

Miscellaneous (Part 1)

India's Partnerships: Vietnam, New Zealand and SAARC

India and Vietnam raised their ties to an enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership after a state visit by To Lam, with a target of USD 25 billion bilateral trade by 2030. India and New Zealand signed a free trade agreement that eliminates duties on Indian exports to New Zealand. The SAARC currency swap framework, launched by the RBI in 2012, offers short-term liquidity support to member nations.

- India and Vietnam elevated ties to an enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership after a state visit by To Lam
- Target: USD 25 billion bilateral trade by 2030
- Vietnam formally joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative
- Joint Vision Statement for 2030 seeks deeper defence cooperation and joint development of advanced defence platforms
- India extended a USD 500 million defence line of credit to Vietnam
- India-New Zealand FTA eliminates duties on Indian exports to New Zealand (100% duty elimination)
- India gives access to 70.03% of tariff lines and keeps 29.97% under exclusion
- New Zealand to invest USD 20 billion over 15 years
- SAARC currency swap: central banks exchange domestic currencies at a predetermined rate and reverse the swap at the same rate
- SAARC swap tenure is 3 months, extendable twice; launched by RBI in 2012

Mind-map outline

India's Partnerships

- Vietnam
 - Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership
 - Trade target: USD 25 billion by 2030
 - Defence line of credit: USD 500 million
- New Zealand FTA
 - 100% duty elimination on Indian exports
 - India gives access to 70.03% tariff lines
 - New Zealand to invest USD 20 billion
- SAARC currency swap
 - Central banks exchange currencies at fixed rate
 - Tenure: 3 months, extendable twice

ASEAN: Structure, Principles and Forums

ASEAN was formed on 8 August 1967 and is headquartered in Jakarta, with 11 members now including Timor-Leste. It works on three principles: non-interference, consensual decision-making and centrality in regional matters, and its Charter took effect in 2008. The group runs several forums and economic pacts, and India's Act East Policy places ASEAN at the centre of its Indo-Pacific vision.

- Formed on 8 August 1967 at Bangkok, Thailand; headquarters in Jakarta, Indonesia
- 11 members, including Timor-Leste (2025)
- Core aims: accelerate economic and social progress, promote regional peace and stability, foster collaboration, cooperate with global organisations
- Principles: non-interference in internal affairs, consensual decision-making, and maintaining centrality in regional matters
- ASEAN Charter took effect on 15 December 2008; it is legally binding and registered with the UN Secretariat
- East Asia Summit created in 2005 as a leaders-level forum with a varied agenda
- ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA) established in 1992 to create a single market
- ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) established in 1994 for political and security dialogue
- ASEAN Economic Community formed in 2015 to facilitate free flow of goods, services, investments, capital and labour
- RCEP concluded in 2019, covering 30% of the world's population

Mnemonic - ASEAN principles: Never Cut Corners

Never = Non-interference in internal affairs of member states; Cut = Consensual decision-making;

Corners = Centrality in regional matters

Mind-map outline

ASEAN

- Basics
 - Formed 8 August 1967
 - Headquarters: Jakarta
 - 11 members, including Timor-Leste
- Principles
 - Non-interference in internal affairs
 - Consensual decision-making
 - Centrality in regional matters
- Forums and pacts
 - East Asia Summit: 2005
 - AFTA: 1992
 - ARF: 1994
 - AEC: 2015
 - RCEP: 2019
- Challenges
 - Geopolitical pressures from China and US
 - South China Sea disputes
 - Myanmar crisis

Global Issues: Thucydides Trap, Ebola and Ecocide

The Thucydides Trap describes the heightened risk of conflict when a rising power challenges an established power, and it is often applied to China and the United States. WHO declared an Ebola outbreak in DR Congo a Public Health Emergency of International Concern, linked to the Bundibugyo strain. Ecocide refers to unlawful or reckless acts that cause severe environmental damage, and it is not currently recognised under the Rome Statute.

- The Thucydides Trap idea originates from Thucydides' account of the Peloponnesian War between Athens and Sparta
- Core argument: growth of Athenian power and the fear it caused in Sparta made conflict increasingly inevitable
- The trap describes a heightened risk of conflict when a rising power challenges an established power
- Critics argue the idea oversimplifies by implying conflict is unavoidable; diplomacy and economic interdependence can prevent escalation
- WHO declared the DR Congo Ebola outbreak a PHEIC, linked to the Bundibugyo strain in the Ituri region
- Under the IHR 2005, a PHEIC is a public health risk of international disease spread requiring coordinated global response
- Ebola is a zoonotic, severe and fatal viral disease, first identified in 1976
- Ecocide: unlawful or reckless acts committed knowing they are likely to cause severe, widespread or long-term environmental damage
- Ecocide is not currently recognised under the Rome Statute; India has not signed the Rome Statute and is not bound by ICC jurisdiction
- Recognised international crimes under the Rome Statute: genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and crime of aggression

Mnemonic - Recognised international crimes: Good Cats Walk Alone

Good = Genocide; Cats = Crimes against humanity; Walk = War crimes; Alone = Crime of aggression

Mind-map outline

Global Issues

- Thucydides Trap
 - Athens vs Sparta in the Peloponnesian War
 - Rising power challenges established power
 - Applied to China and the United States
- Ebola in DR Congo
 - WHO declared a PHEIC
 - Bundibugyo strain, Ituri region
 - Zoonotic, severe and fatal viral disease

- Ecocide
 - Severe, widespread or long-term environmental damage
 - Not recognised under Rome Statute
 - Codified in about 15 countries

Governance, Citizenship and Parliament

Draft Citizenship Rules amendments tighten declaration and passport-surrender norms for applicants from Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh, and India does not allow dual citizenship. A privilege notice moved in Rajya Sabha shows how MPs can allege a breach of parliamentary privilege. The Model Code of Conduct regulates elections, and the Supreme Court's One Case One Data initiative aims to integrate court data.

- Citizenship is covered under Part II (Articles 5 to 11) of the Constitution and is a Union List subject
- India does not allow dual citizenship; acquiring foreign citizenship leads to automatic termination of Indian citizenship
- Applicants must declare whether they hold a valid or expired passport from Pakistan, Afghanistan or Bangladesh
- Under the draft rules, a foreign passport must be surrendered within 15 days
- Citizenship Act, 1955 lists five modes of acquisition: birth, descent, registration, naturalisation and incorporation of territory
- A privilege notice is a formal mechanism to allege breach of parliamentary privilege or contempt of the House; it is derived from Article 105
- Privilege notices are submitted under Lok Sabha Rule 222 or Rajya Sabha Rule 187; the Speaker or Chairman decides whether to allow discussion or refer it to the Privileges Committee
- Model Code of Conduct: non-statutory guidelines issued by the Election Commission to ensure a free, fair and level-playing field, with no unfair advantage to the ruling party
- One Case One Data integrates case data from the Supreme Court, High Courts, district courts and taluka courts into one platform; Su Sahay is an AI chatbot on the Supreme Court website

Mind-map outline

Governance and Citizenship

- Citizenship
 - No dual citizenship in India
 - Foreign citizenship: automatic loss of Indian citizenship
 - Foreign passport surrendered within 15 days
- Parliamentary privilege
 - Privilege notice moved in Rajya Sabha
 - Speaker or Chairman decides on referral
 - Derived from Article 105
- Model Code of Conduct
 - Non-statutory ECI guidelines
 - No misuse of government machinery
- Judicial digital initiatives
 - One Case One Data
 - Su Sahay AI chatbot

Economy, Agriculture and Employment

The RBI's Economic Capital Framework governs how it provides for risks and transfers surplus to the government, and the RBI Board approved a record transfer for FY 2025-26. The Index of Eight Core Industries and the Manufacturing PMI track industrial activity, with the PMI at 54.7 in April 2026. The Mission for Cotton Productivity aims at self-sufficiency in cotton by 2030-31, and the Centre raised the sugarcane Fair and Remunerative Price for the 2026-27 season.

- Economic Capital Framework (introduced in 2019) governs how the RBI provides for financial risks and transfers surplus to the Government of India
- Surplus is transferred to the government only after Contingency Risk Buffer targets are met
- RBI Board approved a record 2.86 lakh crore surplus transfer for FY 2025-26
- Section 47 of the RBI Act, 1934 mandates that RBI profits be sent to the Centre
- RBI surplus transfer typically averages around 0.5% of GDP

- Eight core industries: coal, crude oil, natural gas, refinery products, fertilisers, steel, cement and electricity (base year 2011-12)
- Index of Eight Core Industries grew 1.7% in April 2026; core industries carry a 40.27% weight in the Index of Industrial Production
- Manufacturing PMI rose to 54.7 in April 2026; a PMI above 50 signals expansion, compiled by S&P Global
- Mission for Cotton Productivity (Kapas Kanti), 2026-27 to 2030-31, aims to make India self-sufficient in cotton
- Bt cotton is the only GM crop approved by GEAC for commercial cultivation in India

Mnemonic - Eight core industries: Cats Can Now Really Find Sweet Cream Easily

Cats = Coal; Can = Crude oil; Now = Natural gas; Really = Refinery products; Find = Fertilisers; Sweet = Steel; Cream = Cement; Easily = Electricity

Mind-map outline

Economy and Agriculture

- RBI Economic Capital Framework
 - Surplus transferred after buffer targets met
 - Section 47: profits sent to the Centre
 - Reviewed every 5 years
- Core industries
 - Eight sectors, base year 2011-12
 - 40.27% weight in IIP
- Manufacturing PMI
 - Above 50 signals expansion
 - 54.7 in April 2026
- Cotton Mission
 - Kapas Kanti, 2026-27 to 2030-31
 - Bt cotton: only approved GM crop

Miscellaneous (Part 2)

Governance, Statistics and Panchayats

This subtopic covers the Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0, which grades rural local bodies on a composite score, and the 2025 National Panchayat Awards. It also covers the ASUSE survey of unincorporated enterprises, and the Public Accounts Committee that reviews government expenditure.

- PAI 2.0 was released by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj for FY 2023-24 and covers Gram Panchayats and Traditional Local Bodies.
- Panchayat grades are based on a composite score from 0 to 100.
- Front Runner (A) covers scores of 75-89 and Performer (B) covers scores of 60-74.
- Aspirant (C) covers scores of 40-59 and Beginner (D) covers scores below 40.
- PAI 2.0 translates 17 SDGs into 9 Localised Sustainable Development Goals.
- Tripura had the highest share of Front Runners among top performers, followed by Kerala and Odisha.
- No Panchayat reached the Achiever category in PAI 2.0.
- ASUSE 2025 covered the reference period Jan-Dec 2025, as MoSPI replaced the earlier Oct-Sep cycle with a calendar year.
- National Panchayat Awards 2025 went to 42 Panchayats from 17 States and UTs, with Karnataka winning the most (6).
- The Public Accounts Committee has 22 members (15 Lok Sabha, 7 Rajya Sabha) and was first constituted in 1921.

Mnemonic - PAI 2.0 grade letters: Always Find Progress, Always Begin

A (Achiever) = Top PAI 2.0 grade (A+); no Panchayat reached it; F (Front Runner) = Grade A for composite scores of 75-89; P (Performer) = Grade B for composite scores of 60-74; A (Aspirant) = Grade C for composite scores of 40-59; B (Beginner) = Grade D for composite scores below 40

Mind-map outline

Governance, Statistics and Panchayats

- PAI 2.0 (FY 2023-24)
 - Composite score from 0 to 100

- Grades: A+ to D
- Top: Tripura, Kerala, Odisha
- ASUSE 2025
 - Jan-Dec 2025 reference period
 - Unincorporated non-agricultural sector
- Public Accounts Committee
 - 15 Lok Sabha, 7 Rajya Sabha members
 - Scrutinises CAG reports
- National Panchayat Awards 2025
 - 42 Panchayats, 17 States and UTs
 - Karnataka highest with 6

Environment and Space Missions

MARS is a satellite-based system that detects major methane leaks, and it is being widened to coal mines and waste facilities. SMILE is a joint mission that images how the solar wind interacts with Earth's magnetosphere and ionosphere, helping explain how Earth is shielded from harmful solar radiation.

- MARS (Methane Alert and Response System) is a satellite-based system designed to detect and help mitigate major methane leaks.
- MARS was launched at COP27 (Sharm el-Sheikh) in 2022 and was developed under UNEP's International Methane Emissions Observatory.
- MARS is expanding to coal mines and waste facilities; earlier it focused only on the oil and gas sector.
- Methane has much greater short-term warming potential than carbon dioxide.
- China, the United States and India rank among the world's largest methane emitters.
- The Global Methane Pledge aims to cut global methane emissions by 30% by 2030 compared with 2020 levels; India is not a formal member.
- SMILE was launched by ESA and the Chinese Academy of Sciences aboard a Vega-C rocket from French Guiana.
- SMILE stands for Solar Wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer.
- SMILE provides simultaneous X-ray and ultraviolet imaging of Earth's magnetosphere.
- SMILE helps explain how Earth is protected from harmful solar radiation.

Mnemonic - SMILE acronym: Sun's Magnetic Influence Lights Earth

S (Solar Wind) = Charged particles from the Sun; M (Magnetosphere) = Earth's magnetic shield; I (Ionosphere) = Upper atmospheric layer studied by SMILE; L (Link) = Link between solar wind, magnetosphere and ionosphere; E (Explorer) = The mission is the SMILE spacecraft

Mind-map outline

Environment and Space Missions

- MARS methane system
 - Launched at COP27 in 2022
 - Now covers coal mines and waste
- SMILE mission
 - Solar Wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer
 - X-ray and ultraviolet imaging
- Methane facts
 - Short-term warming above CO₂
 - Global Methane Pledge: 30% cut by 2030

Regional Groupings: SCO and IORA

The SCO is a Eurasian grouping that works to counter terrorism, separatism and extremism, and it gives India access to Central Asia's energy and trade. IORA is a cooperation body for countries bordering the Indian Ocean, and India chairs it for 2025-2027.

- SCO emerged from the Shanghai Five (1996) and became the SCO in 2001 after Uzbekistan joined.
- The SCO's core objective is regional cooperation to counter terrorism, separatism and extremism.
- SCO accounts for about 30% of global GDP and about 40% of the world population.
- SCO has 10 members, including India (joined 2017) and four Central Asian nations.

- The Council of Heads of States is the SCO's supreme decision-making body, and RATS is based in Tashkent.
- The SCO secretariat is in Beijing, and its official languages are Russian and Chinese.
- IORA was established in 1997; its vision originated during Nelson Mandela's 1995 visit to India.
- IORA has 23 Member States and 12 Dialogue Partners, with its secretariat in Ebene (Mauritius).
- IORA cooperation areas include maritime safety and security, fisheries management and disaster risk management.
- The Indian Ocean Dialogue was launched in 2013 in Perth; India hosted editions in 2014, 2019 and 2021.

Mind-map outline

Regional Groupings: SCO and IORA

- SCO
 - Origin: Shanghai Five (1996)
 - Secretariat in Beijing; RATS in Tashkent
- India and SCO
 - Counter-terrorism coordination
 - Access to Central Asian energy
- IORA
 - Established 1997
 - 23 Member States, 12 Dialogue Partners
- Indian Ocean Dialogue
 - Launched 2013 in Perth
 - India hosted 2014, 2019, 2021

Anniversaries and Historical Episodes

Three historical episodes are tied to recent anniversaries: the Korean War of 1950-53, the Komagata Maru voyage of 1914, and Sikkim's integration with India in 1975. Each shows how wars, migration restrictions or treaties shaped the status of a region or its people.

- Japanese occupation of Korea lasted from 1910 to 1945; North and South Korea were established in 1948.
- North Korean troops crossed the 38th Parallel on 25 June 1950, and the UN Security Council condemned the invasion.
- The Korean Armistice Agreement was signed on 27 July 1953, leading to a ceasefire without a peace treaty.
- India chaired the Neutral Nations Repatriation Commission and deployed the Custodian Force India for prisoners unwilling to return.
- The Komagata Maru (Guru Nanak Jahaz), chartered by Gurdit Singh, carried 376 Indian passengers to Canada in 1914.
- Canada's Continuous Journey Regulation (1908) required direct travel from the country of origin; only 24 passengers were allowed to disembark.
- After the ship returned to India, British authorities tried to deport passengers at Budge Budge, and troops opened fire.
- Under the Indo-Sikkim Treaty (1950), Sikkim became an Indian protectorate, with India controlling defence, external affairs and communications.
- The 35th Amendment (1974) gave Sikkim Associate State status, a first in India; a 1975 referendum saw over 97% support for integration.
- The 36th Amendment made Sikkim the 22nd state of India on 16 May 1975, and Article 371F protects its identity and land rights.

Mnemonic - Sikkim's treaties and amendments: Tiny Tigers Calmly Test Associates

T (Titaliya) = Treaty of Titaliya (1817) granted British commercial influence; T (Tumlong) = Treaty of Tumlong (1861) made Sikkim a protectorate of British India; C (Calcutta) = Calcutta Convention (1890) defined the Sikkim-Tibet boundary; T (Treaty) = Indo-Sikkim Treaty (1950) made Sikkim an Indian protectorate; A (Associate) = Associate State status granted in 1974

Mind-map outline

Anniversaries and Historical Episodes

- Korean War (1950-53)
 - Invasion across 38th Parallel, 25 June 1950

- Armistice on 27 July 1953
- No peace treaty; DMZ as buffer
- Komagata Maru (1914)
 - 376 passengers bound for Canada
 - Continuous Journey Regulation (1908)
 - Budge Budge: troops opened fire
- Sikkim integration
 - Namgyal rule, 1642-1975
 - Associate State status in 1974
 - 22nd state on 16 May 1975

Appointments, Peacekeeping and Awards

NS Raja Subramani takes over as the third Chief of Defence Staff from 31 May 2026. The subtopic also covers India's record in UN peacekeeping and recent recognitions, including the International Booker Prize 2026 and the Pulitzer Prize.

- NS Raja Subramani was appointed the 3rd CDS, succeeding Anil Chauhan from 31 May 2026.
- The CDS post was created in 2019 following the Kargil Review Committee (1999) and Shekatkar Committee (2016) recommendations.
- A CDS must be below 62 years at appointment, has no fixed tenure, and can hold office up to age 65.
- The CDS is appointed by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister.
- The CDS is Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee and Secretary of the Department of Military Affairs.
- Major Abhilasha Barak received the UN Military Gender Advocate Award 2025 for work in UNIFIL, Lebanon.
- UN Peacekeeping was founded in 1948; peacekeepers are called Blue Berets or Blue Helmets.
- In 2007 India became the first country to deploy an all-women contingent to a UN peacekeeping mission.
- Taiwan Travelogue won the International Booker Prize 2026, the first Mandarin Chinese-translated novel to win it.
- The Pulitzer Prize is administered by Columbia University and has 23 categories.

Mind-map outline

Appointments, Peacekeeping and Awards

- Chief of Defence Staff
 - NS Raja Subramani, 3rd CDS
 - Created 2019
 - Appointed by Cabinet committee
- UN Peacekeeping
 - Founded 1948
 - Blue Berets or Blue Helmets
 - 2007: first all-women contingent (India)
- Awards
 - International Booker 2026: Taiwan Travelogue
 - Pulitzer: 23 categories, Columbia University
 - UN Gender Advocate 2025: Major Abhilasha Barak

AILET Corner

AILET Corner: Current Affairs May 2026

International Cooperation and Financial Links

India's external cooperation in the May 2026 round includes SEEDS, a Ministry of External Affairs initiative that supports small and medium enterprises in the Global South. The booklet also covers a labour-rights complaint route under ILO Article 24 and a revised RBI and ECB memorandum on banking supervision. The Eurozone entry explains the euro area's membership, its 1998 founding and its central bank.

- SEEDS stands for Supply of Equipment for Efficient Development of SMEs and is implemented by the Ministry of External Affairs.

- SEEDS is an Indian developmental cooperation initiative aimed at supporting SMEs in Global South countries.
- Subrahmanyam Jaishankar inaugurated India-supported SEEDS projects in Trinidad and Tobago.
- Tea plantation workers in West Bengal invoked ILO Article 24, alleging labour rights violations in tea estates.
- Article 24 is a formal mechanism through which industrial associations of workers or employers can complain against a member country that fails to implement a ratified ILO Convention.
- The Tea Act 1953 established the Tea Board to regulate cultivation, production, sale and export of Indian tea.
- The RBI and the ECB signed a revised MoU to enhance cooperation in banking supervision and financial regulation.
- The Eurozone is a group of EU countries that use the euro as their official currency and has 21 member countries.
- The Eurozone was established in 1998 under the Maastricht Treaty; recent additions are Croatia (2023) and Bulgaria (2026).
- The ECB is headquartered in Frankfurt and is collectively owned by the national central banks of all 27 EU member states.

Mnemonic - SEEDS acronym: Sow SEEDS for SMEs abroad

S = Supply of equipment; E = Equipment; E = Efficient development; D = Development; S = SMEs (small and medium enterprises)

Mind-map outline

International Cooperation and Financial Links

- SEEDS
 - Supply of Equipment for Efficient Development of SMEs
 - Implemented by MEA
 - Projects in Trinidad and Tobago
- ILO Article 24
 - Invoked by tea workers, West Bengal
 - Complaint against member country
 - Ratified ILO Convention not implemented
- Tea Board
 - Created by Tea Act 1953
 - Regulates cultivation, sale and export
- RBI-ECB MoU
 - Banking supervision
 - Financial regulation
- Eurozone
 - 21 member countries
 - Established 1998, Maastricht Treaty
 - Recent: Croatia 2023, Bulgaria 2026

Defence and Border Infrastructure

The Kalam & Kavach 3.0 conference in New Delhi discussed India's defence transformation and military modernisation. DRDO and the Indian Air Force tested the TARA weapon system, which turns an unguided warhead into a precision-guided weapon. The Border Roads Organisation, established in 1960, builds infrastructure in high-altitude and strategically sensitive border areas.

- Kalam & Kavach 3.0 was the 3rd edition of the defence conference, held in New Delhi and organised by the Ministry of Defence.
- The conference is a high-level platform for India's defence transformation, military modernisation and future preparedness.
- JAI stands for Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation.
- TARA stands for Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation.
- DRDO and the Indian Air Force conducted the maiden flight trial of the TARA weapon system.
- TARA is an indigenous glide weapon system.
- Its modular range-extension kit attaches to an existing unguided warhead to convert it into a precision-guided weapon.

- The Border Roads Organisation was established in 1960 and is India's premier agency for border infrastructure.
- BRO works in high-altitude, remote and strategically sensitive areas and has its headquarters in New Delhi.
- BRO's Project Deepak (1961) operates in the Western Himalayas.

Mnemonic - JAI pillars: Take JAI forward

J = Jointness; A = Aatmanirbharta; I = Innovation

Mind-map outline

Defence and Border Infrastructure

- Kalam & Kavach 3.0
 - 3rd edition, New Delhi
 - Organised by Ministry of Defence
 - Modernisation and future preparedness
- TARA weapon system
 - Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation
 - DRDO and IAF maiden trial
 - Range-extension kit for unguided warhead
- Border Roads Organisation
 - Established 1960
 - High-altitude and sensitive areas
 - Headquarters New Delhi

Environment, Wildlife and Weather

Human-elephant conflict is addressed through Project Elephant (1992), the Haathi Mere Saathi campaign and Project RE-HAB, which uses bees to deter elephants. Jharkhand is set to establish a dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre at Palamu Tiger Reserve. Mission Mausam's urban testbed and aerosol observatory in Chennai tracks urban weather, air quality and aerosols.

- Jharkhand is set to establish India's dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre at Palamu Tiger Reserve.
- Project Elephant was launched in 1992 by the Government of India to protect elephants and conserve their habitats and corridors.
- The Haathi Mere Saathi campaign promotes coexistence between humans and elephants.
- Retaliatory violence is to be reduced through public awareness, community sensitisation and conservation education.
- Project RE-HAB stands for Reducing Elephant-Human Attacks using Bees and is implemented by the Khadi and Village Industries Commission.
- The Ministry of Earth Sciences inaugurated an Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory under Mission Mausam.
- The Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory was set up by the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology in Chennai.
- The Integrated Atmospheric Monitoring System is designed for real-time urban weather observation, air quality monitoring, aerosol tracking and climate-related research.

Mnemonic - RE-HAB acronym: Bees help REHAB elephant conflict

R = Reducing; E = Elephant; H = Human; A = Attacks; B = using Bees

Mind-map outline

Environment, Wildlife and Weather

- Human-elephant conflict
 - Project Elephant, 1992
 - Haathi Mere Saathi campaign
 - Reduce retaliatory violence
 - Research centre at Palamu Tiger Reserve
- Project RE-HAB
 - Uses bees
 - Implemented by KVIC
- Urban testbed under Mission Mausam
 - Inaugurated by Ministry of Earth Sciences
 - Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, Chennai

- Real-time urban weather and air quality

Governance, Crime Data and Remembrance

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, with the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies, launched a National AI Skilling Initiative for the creative sector, developed with Google and YouTube. The National Crime Records Bureau, set up in 1986 under the Ministry of Home Affairs, released Crime in India 2024, which covers offences under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita alongside the IPC. A statue of Veera Pasi was unveiled in Raebareli to recognise the heroes of the 1857 revolt.

- The National AI Skilling Initiative for the Creative Sector aims to build industry-ready AI capabilities in India's creative industries.
- The initiative aims to strengthen India's creative economy and digital content ecosystem.
- Target sectors are Media, Animation, Gaming, Digital Storytelling and Content Creation.
- The initiative is developed in partnership with Google and YouTube and implemented by the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies.
- The NCRB was established in 1986 and acts as India's central repository of crime and criminal data.
- The NCRB functions under the Ministry of Home Affairs and its recommendations were based on the Tandon Committee and the National Police Commission.
- The NCRB's Crime in India 2024 report includes offences registered under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita alongside the IPC.
- Veera Pasi was a warrior of the Pasi community of Uttar Pradesh who served as a commander under Rana Beni Madhav Baksh Singh.
- Veera Pasi is remembered as a Dalit freedom fighter who took part in the Revolt of 1857 against British colonial rule.

Mind-map outline

Governance, Crime Data and Remembrance

- National AI Skilling Initiative
 - Ministry of Information and Broadcasting with IICT
 - Partners: Google and YouTube
 - Target: media, animation, gaming
- NCRB
 - Established 1986
 - Under Ministry of Home Affairs
 - Crime in India 2024 includes BNS offences
- Veera Pasi
 - Pasi community warrior, Uttar Pradesh
 - Commander under Rana Beni Madhav Baksh Singh
 - 1857 revolt; Raebareli statue